TOMISLAV MESARIĆ

Butcher | Meat Counter Assistant

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Qualified butcher with experience in carcass breakdown, boning, trimming, portioning and customer service across a family butcher shop and a market meat counter. Skilled in fresh sausage production, FIFO stock rotation and HACCP knowledge, including temperature and hygiene checks. Experienced in training apprentices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher | Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb

2019–Present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Produce around 40 kg of fresh sausages per week in the busy season, including ćevapi, kobasice, chipolata and lamb merguez.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback; the ćevapi won second place at the 2023 Zagreb County craft meat fair.
- Rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, placing the oldest stock at the front.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice daily.
- Serve around 120 customers on Saturdays, advising on cuts, quantities and cooking times.
- Train two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting events, including ordering, butchering, seasoning and delivery. Completed orders for three weddings and around 10 family parties annually; largest order was four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs, recording temperature and weight loss; the shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order.

Counter Assistant | Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb

2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers, the counter and floor drain at closing.
- Wrote a one-page closing and cleaning checklist following a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme) | Food Trades School Zagreb, 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate | 2021; renewed 2024

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown: beef, pork and lamb | Boning, trimming and portioning | Fresh sausage making | FIFO stock rotation | HACCP temperature and hygiene checks | Knife sharpening | Mincer and bandsaw operation | Customer service and product advice | Cash handling | Cleaning and sanitising equipment

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (good) | German (basic)